

【読解演習第1回】

次の英文を読んで、下記の設問に答えよ。

In an effort to be more environmentally friendly, (1)many countries around the world are trying to limit the number of cars that enter their cities. One way is to encourage people to use public transport, such as buses and trains. Another way is to encourage people to use bicycles. Of course, too many bicycles could also be a problem, so a recent trend is for public bicycle renting systems.

Paris began a public bicycle renting system several years ago. Membership can be for a day, a month or a year, but people are free to use the system from morning to evening simply by using a credit card. Users can have a bicycle for half an hour at no cost, but then pay for every 30 minutes after that. The rental fee also rises for each extra 30 minutes. In this way, it is hoped that people will use them for short trips only.

The Paris system is the biggest public bicycle renting system in the world, with 20,000 bicycles and 1,600 bicycle stations. It is so easy and successful that it has 130,000 users per day. (2)Many are tourists and visitors to the city of Paris who find that renting a bicycle is both more efficient and cheaper than using *the Metro train system.

The Paris bicycle renting system is mainly supported by a private advertising company. They buy the bicycles and also pay for their repair and the bicycle stations. In return for financing the system, the company can use the bicycles and stations for advertising.

(3)Public bicycle renting systems are a wonderful idea and with the help of private companies they can be created without spending public money. There are a number of extra benefits. Besides less air pollution cities are also quieter. (4)It also makes the city more attractive for citizens and visitors, but the biggest bonus is one of public health as people become more aware of the ease and joy of using a bicycle.

(注) the Metro train system: (パリの)地下鉄

設 問

- (1) 下線部(1)のような活動が促進される理由としてあなたが考えることを、40語程度の英語で述べよ。
- (2) 下線部(2)を和訳せよ。
- (3) 下線部(3)を和訳せよ。
- (4) 下線部(4)を和訳せよ。

(1)

(2)

(3)

(4)

【読解演習第2回】

次の英文を読んで、下記の設問に答えよ。

Most people assume that their memories accurately capture what happened in the past and that these memories are permanent. Unfortunately, ⁽¹⁾memories do change over time. They are not an objective record of the past, as though a video of an event had been saved on a mental hard disk. Rather, memories are reconstructed, and their reconstruction is influenced by current attitudes, beliefs, and available information. This reconstructive nature of the past means that how we think and feel today influences how we remember yesterday. ⁽²⁾Even such subtle influences as the way in which we are asked about the past can dramatically influence our memory of "what really happened."

設 問

- (1) 下線部(1)のようにいえるのはなぜか、日本語で説明せよ。
- (2) 下線部(2)を和訳せよ。
- (3) 下線部(2)について、あなたが思うところを40語程度の英語で述べよ。

(1)

(2)

(3)

【読解演習第3回】

1 次の英文を読んで、下記の設問に答えよ。

Some hospital patients surprise medical staff by expressing positive emotions about their current situation, despite being seriously ill. (1)It is tempting to assume that patients who say that they feel contented with their lives are simply refusing to face up to the facts.

But there is another possible explanation. Perhaps those chronically ill patients who express positive emotions are actually coping well with their lives despite their condition. (2)In that case, the emotions that they are expressing will be those that they genuinely feel.

設 問

- (1) 下線部(1)を和訳せよ。
- (2) 下線部(2)とは具体的にどのような場合か、日本語で説明せよ。

2 次の英文についてあなたはどうか考えるか、50語程度の英語で述べよ。

There is a bright future waiting for us.

1

(1)

(2)

2

【読解演習第4回】

次の英文を読んで、下記の設問に答えよ。

Many people, and scientists in particular, find it extremely difficult to come to terms with the idea that there are some animals who may be as intelligent as we are. Perhaps, (1)this reaction is not altogether surprising, as we too firmly believe in (2)the myth that we are the most intelligent life-form on the planet.

The notion that animals were not capable of thought or feelings was put forward as early as the 16th century. (3)A French philosopher proposed that animals were automatic machines not guided by a mind, whereas humans had a mind, free will and the ability to think.

設 問

- (1) 下線部(1)の具体的内容を日本語で説明せよ。
- (2) 下線部(2)の具体的内容を日本語で説明せよ。
- (3) 下線部(3)を和訳せよ。
- (4) 下線部(3)の一部分

“animals were automatic machines not guided by a mind”

についてあなたはどうか考えるか、50語程度の英語で述べよ。

(1)

(2)

(3)

(4)

【読解演習第5回】

次の英文を読んで、下記の設問に答えよ。

English is a language which is used by a lot of people all over the world. It is spoken in England, in Canada, in the U.S.A., in Australia, and in New Zealand. It is also spoken in other parts of the world. Only Chinese is spoken by more people.

In some countries many different languages are spoken. In one country people have over ten languages. ⁽¹⁾They speak one language in one part of the country, and in another part of the country they speak another. When two people from different parts of the country meet, they cannot understand each other. They don't know both of the languages. How can people with different native languages understand each other? ⁽²⁾In such a case English is used.

In another country people buy from some countries and sell to other countries, so they believe it is important for them to learn English. Students must learn two languages, English and their own language, and in a lot of schools almost all the lessons are given in English.

Scientists often meet to talk about things they are studying. They come from different countries. But most of them can read and write in English, so English is very often used as a common language.

English is now the language of many of the world's people. There are different ways of speaking and pronouncing English in different parts of the world. ⁽³⁾Sometimes even Americans cannot understand British people. English is different from place to place and changes little by little. If you think about your own language, you can understand this.

設 問

- (1) 下線部(1)を和訳せよ。
- (2) 下線部(2)とは具体的にどのような場合か、日本語で説明せよ。
- (3) 下線部(3)のような状況が生じるのはなぜか、日本語で説明せよ。
- (4) 以下の英文に対するあなたの意見を、理由を添えて、60語程度の英語で述べよ。

The university entrance exams in Japan should place a higher emphasis on English.

(1)

(2)

(3)

(4)

【読解演習第6回】

以下の英文を読んで、下記の設問に答えよ。

The telephone, television, radio and telegraph all help people communicate with each other. Because of these devices, ideas, and news of events spread quickly all over the world. For example, within seconds, people can know the results of an election in Japan or Argentina. An international soccer match comes into the home of everyone with a television set.

News of such disasters as an earthquake and a flood can bring help from distant countries. Within hours, help is on the way.

How has this speed of communication changed the world? To many people (1)the world has become smaller. Two hundred years ago, communication between the continents took a long time. All news was carried on ships that took weeks or even months to cross the oceans. In the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries, it took six weeks for news from Europe to reach the Americas. This time difference influenced people's actions. For example, one battle or fight in the War of 1812 between England and the United States could have been avoided.

A peace agreement had already been signed. Peace was made in England, but the news of peace took six weeks to reach America. During this six weeks, the large and serious Battle of New Orleans was fought. Many people lost their lives after the peace treaty had been signed. (2)They would not have died if news had come faster.

The spread of communication means that all people of the world have a new responsibility. People in different countries must try harder to understand each other. (3)An example is that people with different religious beliefs must try to understand each other's beliefs and values even if they do not accept them. Sometimes their cultures are quite different. (4)What one group considers a normal part of life is strange to another culture.

In some cases, a normal part of one culture might be bad or impolite to other people. This kind of difference can cause misunderstanding.

(5)People must learn not to judge others, but to accept them as they are. Then understanding between cultures can be better. Misunderstandings can be avoided.

設 問

- (1) 下線部(1)とはどういうことか、日本語で説明せよ。
- (2) 下線部(2)のようにいえるのはなぜか、日本語で説明せよ。
- (3) 下線部(3)を和訳せよ。
- (4) 下線部(4)を和訳せよ。
- (5) 下線部(5)を和訳せよ。

(1)

(2)

(3)

(4)

(5)

【読解演習第7回】

以下の英文を読んで、下記の設問に答えよ。

"Oh, you speak English very well," a member of your American host family tells you. Generally, Americans are very good at making compliments. It is said that in America compliments are like motor oil. They keep American society running smoothly.

American parents praise their children both inside and outside the home. They will proudly tell their friends and neighbors about their son's or daughter's achievements. Compare this to Japan, where parents seldom praise their children in front of other people. Instead, Japanese parents often complain about their youngsters even if they are the best students in their class.

American teachers and professors praise their students frequently both in class and outside of class. "You did an excellent job!" "How smart!" "I'm very proud of you!" "Nice work!" "Well done!" "Perfect ten!" "You hit the nail on the head! These are some typical expressions teachers use when they want to praise their students. Most American teachers are aware of the importance of building self-esteem and confidence in young people.

In business also, praise and compliments are an important part of communication between management and worker. Employees lose morale when they feel their work isn't valued. As a result, work quality can decrease. Therefore, management training courses stress the importance of giving praise for good work. (2)Workers are more likely to cooperate with a manager who gives praise and encouragement, rather than one who complains.

Of course, praise and compliments must be believable. Insincere praise, also known as flattery, causes discomfort and uncertainty. People wonder why the person is giving (3)empty praise and they become suspicious. They might even lose respect for the person giving the compliment.

(4)Therefore, Americans are particularly mindful about giving appropriate praise and compliments to the people around them. Mark Twain, the great nineteenth century American writer, once said, "I can live for two months on a good compliment."

設 問

- (1) 第2段落で述べられている、日本の親とアメリカの親の子に対する接し方の違いについて、両者を対比させて、日本語で説明せよ。
- (2) 下線部(2)を和訳せよ。
- (3) 下線部(3)が指す内容を日本語で説明せよ。
- (4) 下線部(4)を和訳せよ。

(1)

(2)

(3)

(4)
